

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Prefix multi-

Today I am learning to use multi- to interpret and build academic vocabulary.

1 Learn the Meaning

The prefix multi- means many or multiple. In academic and technical words, it often shows that something has several parts, involves many groups, or works across more than one area.

multilingual

using several languages

multimedia

using several forms of media

multinational

involving several nations

multicellular

made of many cells

2 Build the Word

Add multi- and explain the whole word.

Base / related	Prefix	New word	Meaning clue
lingual	multi-	_____	_____
media	multi-	_____	_____
national	multi-	_____	_____
cellular	multi-	_____	_____
disciplinary	multi-	_____	_____
purpose	multi-	_____	_____

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage. Highlight the multi- words, then use structure and context to explain them.

During a regional sustainability forum, a multidisciplinary team investigated how cities could reduce waste. The group included scientists, designers, economists and community leaders, so each problem was examined from multiple perspectives. A multilingual student helped translate key ideas for visitors, while a multimedia display combined maps, video, graphs and interviews. One presentation compared multinational companies that operate in several countries and considered how their decisions can affect local communities.

Another session explored multicellular organisms and showed how many specialised cells work together in one living system. The speakers repeatedly used multi- to signal more than one part, group or form. Rather than memorising each word separately, the students broke unfamiliar vocabulary into meaningful parts and then checked the whole meaning in context. This helped them see how the same prefix can support understanding across science, geography, economics and communication.

4 Word Detective

a Write a multi- word from the passage.

b What base or related word can you identify?

c What does multi- contribute?

d Paraphrase the whole word in plain English.

5 Sort the Words

Sort by what multi- signals.

Words:

multilingual multimedia multinational multicellular
multidisciplinary multipurpose

Many groups / fields

Many parts / forms

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

a A multidisciplinary team is useful when

b Use a different multi- word in a sentence.

Parent check

☐ Recognises multi- as meaning many / multiple

☐ Identifies a meaningful base or related word

☐ Explains the whole word, not only the prefix

☐ Uses multi- vocabulary accurately in context

Capture idea: Find a multi- word in science, geography, media or another subject. Record the word, its base, and a plain-English meaning.